SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

12 July 2022 · Shift 2

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 24 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A keeper or custodian of a museum

(A) Creator
(B) Developer
(C) Master
(D) Curator

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. The list included many “mundane,” routine tasks.

(A) standard
(B) temporal
(C) customary
(D) exceptional

Q.3

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. The smell of this flower “make me felt dizzy.”

(A) making I feel
(B) makes me feel
(C) make me feeling
(D) No improvement required

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Hurdle

(A) Progress
(B) Impediment
(C) Accessory
(D) Aid

Q.5

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Apart from Germany, they also visited Italy and Austria during its business trip.

(A) also visited Italy and Austria
(B) during its business trip
(C) Apart from Germany, they
(D) No error.

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Suspend all the employees “which has been coming” late.

(A) who have been coming
(B) who had came
(C) that was been coming
(D) No improvement required

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Any award, honour or laudatory notice

(A) Complement
(B) Deal
(C) Statute
(D) Accolade

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Thinking of talent as innate makes our world more manageable and more comfortable as it relieves a person of the _____ of expectation.

(A) blessing
(B) assistance
(C) burden
(D) compensation

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Agitate

(A) Blame
(B) Strike
(C) Distress
(D) Soothe

Q.10

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. But this immortality / will have purchased / at the price of / his immortal part.

(A) will have purchased
(B) at the price of
(C) his immortal part
(D) But this immortality

Q.11

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Tendency
(B) Tendensy
(C) Tendincy
(D) Tendancy

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. As he went through the street on an _____ that morning, he saw a woman with a cat under her arm.

(A) Objection
(B) encasement
(C) Errand
(D) Amendment

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Something happening in three years

(A) Annual
(B) Triennial
(C) Biennial
(D) millennial

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We are selling a single orange _____ ₹10 but nobody is ready to buy it.

(A) on
(B) to
(C) with
(D) for

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. I had never seen him lose his temper, and he governed our company with “an iron hand.”

(A) In anxiety
(B) At the service
(C) To any degree
(D) strict and harsh control

Q.17

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Residents should keep an / eye out for strangers / acting suspecting in their areas

(A) eye out for strangers
(B) No error
(C) Residents should keep an
(D) acting suspecting in their areas

Q.18

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. When a plastic comb is rubbed on dry hair, "they acquired a" static charge.

(A) it acquired a
(B) it acquires a
(C) they acquire an
(D) No improvement required

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. "Come rain or shine," I will go to Paris tomorrow.

(A) At the last moment
(B) Whatever happens
(C) To decide later
(D) To come before the decided time

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Laborious

(A) Unsophisticated
(B) Profane
(C) Assiduous
(D) Pompous

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Coca-Cola is to become the new sponsor of the London Eye after (1) _____ a deal to replace France's EDF Energy. The capital's giant Ferris Wheel has been a (2) _____ tourist attraction since it was introduced in 2000, when it was (3) _____ as the Millennium Wheel. It was previously (4) _____ by British Airways before becoming the EDF Energy London Eye in 2011. Coca-Cola will take over in January after (5) _____ a two-year deal with the wheel's owner, Merlin Entertainments, for an undisclosed sum.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) Assorting
(B) Enclosing
(C) Clearing
(D) Signing

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Coca-Cola is to become the new sponsor of the London Eye after (1) _____ a deal to replace France's EDF Energy. The capital's giant Ferris Wheel has been a (2) _____ tourist attraction since it was introduced in 2000, when it was (3) _____ as the Millennium Wheel. It was previously (4) _____ by British Airways before becoming the EDF Energy London Eye in 2011. Coca-Cola will take over in January after (5) _____ a two-year deal with the wheel's owner, Merlin Entertainments, for an undisclosed sum.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) Leading
(B) Susceptible
(C) Supportive
(D) Mandatory

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Coca-Cola is to become the new sponsor of the London Eye after (1) _____ a deal to replace France's EDF Energy. The capital's giant Ferris Wheel has been a (2) _____ tourist attraction since it was introduced in 2000, when it was (3) _____ as the Millennium Wheel. It was previously (4) _____ by British Airways before becoming the EDF Energy London Eye in 2011. Coca-Cola will take over in January after (5) _____ a two-year deal with the wheel's owner, Merlin Entertainments, for an undisclosed sum.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Based
(B) Inscribed
(C) Published
(D) Known

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Coca-Cola is to become the new sponsor of the London Eye after (1) _____ a deal to replace France's EDF Energy. The capital's giant Ferris Wheel has been a (2) _____ tourist attraction since it was introduced in 2000, when it was (3) _____ as the Millennium Wheel. It was previously (4) _____ by British Airways before becoming the EDF Energy London Eye in 2011. Coca-Cola will take over in January after (5) _____ a two-year deal with the wheel's owner, Merlin Entertainments, for an undisclosed sum.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Sponsored
(B) Refused
(C) kept
(D) Authenticated

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Coca-Cola is to become the new sponsor of the London Eye after (1) _____ a deal to replace France's EDF Energy. The capital's giant Ferris Wheel has been a (2) _____ tourist attraction since it was introduced in 2000, when it was (3) _____ as the Millennium Wheel. It was previously (4) _____ by British Airways before becoming the EDF Energy London Eye in 2011. Coca-Cola will take over in January after (5) _____ a two-year deal with the wheel's owner, Merlin Entertainments, for an undisclosed sum.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) Striking
(B) Discovering
(C) Forging
(D) Hedging

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. TOM, UMP, VKS, ?, XGY

(A) WHU
(B) WIV
(C) WIU
(D) WHV

Q.2

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 121, 144, 169, ?, 225, 256

(A) 196
(B) 192
(C) 188
(D) 194

Q.3

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number-pair. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 17 : 19

(A) 23 : 27
(B) 43 : 53
(C) 29 : 31
(D) 31 : 41

Q.4

In a certain code language, 'GANT' is coded as '126', and 'PROM' is coded as '186'. How will 'GAIL' be coded in that language?

(A) 63
(B) 79
(C) 58
(D) 87

Q.5

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All X are B. II. All N are X. Conclusions: I. All N are B. II. Some B are X.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. RL : VJ :: AN : ?

(A) FL
(B) EL
(C) FM
(D) EM

Q.10

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '× ' are interchanged and also '5' and '9' are interchanged? 3 + 9 – 6 × 5 ÷ 3 = ?

(A) 10
(B) 16
(C) 12
(D) 14

Q.11

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. GAP : EYN :: MAD : KYB :: FILE : ?

(A) EJGC
(B) DGJC
(C) EHKD
(D) DKHE

Q.12

By interchanging the given two signs, which of the following equations will NOT be correct? × and –; I. 17 – 21 + 86 ÷ 2 × 13 = 387; II. 10 + 63 – 12 × 259 ÷ 7 = 739

(A) Equation I
(B) Equation II
(C) Neither I nor II
(D) Both I and II

Q.13

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some mangoes are radish and no radish is an apple. All apples are tomatoes. Conclusions: I: All radish being tomatoes is a possibility. II: Some radishes are tomatoes.

(A) Neither I nor II follows
(B) Only I follows
(C) Only II follows
(D) Both I and II follow

Q.14

Seven boys B1, B2, B3, B4, B5, B6 and B7 are sitting around a circular table, facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). B3 is second to the left of B6. B1 is third to the left of B3. B7 is third to the left of B6. B4 is not the immediate neighbour of B6. B2 is not the immediate neighbour of B1, B5 is the immediate neighbour of B1 and B6.. Three out of the following four options are similar by a certain logic and form a group. Which of the following does NOT belong to that group?

(A) B3, B6, B1
(B) B6, B1, B7
(C) B2, B5, B4
(D) B7, B4, B1

Q.15

In a certain code language, 'SLID' is written as 'TMHC', and 'LIST' is written as 'MJRS'. How will 'PILE' be written in that code language?

(A) QIKC
(B) OHMF
(C) OMHF
(D) QJKD

Q.16

6 persons A, B, C, D, E and F are sitting around a rectangular table (not necessarily in the same order) facing towards the centre. 4 persons are sitting at each corner, and one person is sitting at the middle of each shorter side of the table. B is an immediate neighbour of D and C. F is an immediate neighbour of A and D. E is an immediate neighbour of A and C. F is not sitting at any of the corners. Which of the following pairs represents the persons who are sitting exactly opposite to each other?

(A) CD
(B) FC
(C) AD
(D) BE

Q.17

Seven friends A, B, C, D, E, F and G have a different number of bikes. D has more bikes than F, but less bikes than G. F has less bikes than A, and A does not have the highest number of bikes. Four persons have more bikes than C. E has the least and D has the third highest number of bikes. B has less bikes than G. Who has the highest number of bikes?

(A) B
(B) G
(C) D
(D) A

Q.18

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 8 : 32 :: 12 : 72 :: 18 : ?

(A) 180
(B) 234
(C) 208
(D) 162

Q.19

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 16, 32, 14, 19, 37, 21, 22, 42, ?, 25, 47, 35

(A) 34
(B) 26
(C) 32
(D) 28

Q.21

In a certain code language, '693' means 'Neha likes cakes', '135' means 'cakes are sweet', '254' means 'we are girls', then what is the code for 'sweet' in the same code language?

(A) 3
(B) 5
(C) 2
(D) 1

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'GRAY' is coded as ‘718125', 'FOMK' is coded as ‘6151311'. How will 'CBHL' be coded in that code language?

(A) 23812
(B) 32812
(C) 38212
(D) 32821

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Water : Thirst :: Food : Hunger :: Rest : ?

(A) Thought
(B) Wine
(C) Exhaustion
(D) Intoxication

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following dances is popularly known as the Gotipua Dance?

(A) Garba
(B) Bandha Nritya
(C) Bhangra
(D) Lavani

Q.2

Which Article of the Indian Constitution states that ‘The State shall endeavour to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India’?

(A) Article 40
(B) Article 42
(C) Article 46
(D) Article 44

Q.3

What is the total stock of money in circulation among the public at a particular point of time called?

(A) Money order
(B) Money supply
(C) Short money
(D) Money laundering

Q.4

Who is the first Indian woman to win the Grammy Award?

(A) Sunidhi Chauhan
(B) Lata Mangeshkar
(C) Asha Bhosle
(D) Tanvi Shah

Q.5

How many General Elections to the Lok Sabha have been held till April 2022?

(A) 24
(B) 13
(C) 17
(D) 10

Q.6

Sri Lanka is separated from India by the _____.

(A) Strait of Malacca
(B) Strait of Gibraltar
(C) Palk Strait
(D) Bering Strait

Q.7
In which state does the Tapi river originate?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Karnataka

Q.8
The Government of India initiated the comprehensive Family Planning Programme in _____.

(A) 1954
(B) 1958
(C) 1952
(D) 1955

Q.9
Under whose captainship did India win all three major ICC trophies in white-ball cricket till 2021?

(A) Kapil Dev
(B) Virat Kohli
(C) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(D) Sourav Ganguly

Q.10
Gautamiputra Shri Satakarni was a ruler of which dynasty?

(A) Rashtrakuta
(B) Satavahana
(C) Chola
(D) Chera

Q.11
Who among the following was a leader of the Khilafat Movement?

(A) Bhagat Singh
(B) Kasturba Gandhi
(C) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
(D) Jyotiba Phule

Q.12
Which of the following teams won the first edition of ISL (Indian Super League)?

(A) Bengaluru FC
(B) Chennaiyin FC
(C) Atletico de Kolkata
(D) Kerala Blasters FC

Q.13
In which state of India is the Nongkrem dance festival celebrated?

(A) Bihar
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Kerala
(D) Meghalaya

Q.14
In which year, did Sher Khan defeat Humayun at Kanauj?

(A) 1541
(B) 1543
(C) 1540
(D) 1542

Q.15
Which of the following diseases is caused by insulin deficiency or insulin resistance?

(A) Diabetes
(B) Flu
(C) Cough
(D) Beri Beri

Q.16
Who became the first woman Chairperson of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) in 2022?

(A) Madhabi Puri Buch
(B) Rekha Sharma
(C) Chanda Kochhar
(D) Gita Gopinath

Q.17
Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) 2005 provides _____ days of assured employment every year to every rural household.

(A) 100
(B) 120
(C) 150
(D) 200

Q.18
Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, while presenting Union Budget for 2022-23 announced a programme called 'Parvatmala'. This programme was announced to develop _____.

(A) smart houses in hilly areas
(B) ropeways in hilly areas
(C) hospitality culture in hilly areas
(D) roads in hilly areas

Q.19
'The Race of My Life : An Autobiography' is the autobiography of which of the following persons?

(A) Dutee Chand
(B) Tintu Luka
(C) PT Usha
(D) Milkha Singh

Q.20
The splitting of white light into its component colours is called _____.

(A) refraction
(B) reflection
(C) scattering
(D) dispersion

Q.21
After the Revolt of 1857 was put down by Britishers, which Mughal ruler was forced to leave the country?

(A) Bahadur Shah Zafar
(B) Farrukhsiyar
(C) Ahmad Shah Bahadur
(D) Muhammad Shah

Q.22
Which of the following is known as artificial silk?

(A) Acrylic
(B) Nylon
(C) Polyester
(D) Rayon

Q.23
Which of the following is a warm current?

(A) Labrador current
(B) Falkland current
(C) Canary current
(D) Gulf stream

Q.24
Which Bharatanatyam dancer became the second youngest dancer to be honoured with the 'Padma Shri' award in 1991?

(A) Hema Malini
(B) Narthaki Nataraj
(C) Saroj Khan
(D) Alarmel Valli

Q.25
Mukteshwara Temple is a 10th-century Hindu temple dedicated to Shiva, located in _____.

(A) Assam
(B) Odisha
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Gujarat

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Curator

A curator is the person in charge of a museum's or gallery's collection.

Q.2 · Answer (D) exceptional

'Mundane' means dull and ordinary, so its opposite is 'exceptional'. 'Standard' and 'customary' are close to its meaning.

Q.3 · Answer (B) makes me feel

'The smell' is singular, so the verb is 'makes', and 'make' is followed by the bare infinitive 'feel': 'The smell of this flower makes me feel dizzy.' (The sheet's underline also takes in 'dizzy.', which the options leave out.)

Q.4 · Answer (B) Impediment

A hurdle is an obstacle, an 'impediment'. 'Progress' and 'aid' are nearly opposite.

Q.5 · Answer (B) during its business trip

The subject 'they' is plural, so the possessive must be 'their': 'during their business trip'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) who have been coming

Employees are people, so the relative pronoun is 'who', and the plural noun takes 'have': 'Suspend all the employees who have been coming late.'

Q.7 · Answer (D) Accolade

An accolade is an award or an expression of praise. A 'complement' completes something, and a 'statute' is a law.

Q.8 · Answer (C) burden

To be relieved of something is to be freed from a weight: seeing talent as inborn frees a person from the 'burden' of expectation.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Soothe

To 'agitate' is to disturb or excite; its opposite is to 'soothe', to calm. 'Distress' is close to its meaning.

Q.10 · Answer (A) will have purchased

Immortality is what is bought, not the buyer, so the verb must be passive: 'will have been purchased'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Tendency

The correct spelling is 'tendency', ending in '-ency'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Errand

An errand is a short trip to do a task, such as buying or delivering something; one goes 'on an errand'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Triennial

'Triennial' means happening every three years. 'Annual' is every year, 'biennial' every two years and 'millennial' every thousand years.

Q.15 · Answer (D) for

The price something is sold at is introduced by 'for': to sell an orange 'for ₹10'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) strict and harsh control

To govern 'with an iron hand' is to keep strict and harsh control.

Q.17 · Answer (D) acting suspecting in their areas

The verb 'acting' needs an adverb of manner: 'acting suspiciously', not 'acting suspecting'.

Q.18 · Answer (B) it acquires a

The subject 'a plastic comb' is singular, so the pronoun is 'it', and a general fact takes the simple present: 'it acquires a static charge'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Whatever happens
'Come rain or shine' means whatever happens, in any circumstances.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Assiduous
Said of a person, 'laborious' means hard-working and industrious, which is what 'assiduous' (diligent, persevering) means. 'Unsophisticated', 'profane' (irreverent) and 'pompous' have nothing to do with effort.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Signing
Coca-Cola becomes the sponsor after 'signing' a deal, that is formally agreeing to one.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Leading
A 'leading' tourist attraction is one of the most popular: the wheel has been one since it opened in 2000.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Known
'Known as' gives the name it went by: when it was introduced in 2000 it was called the Millennium Wheel.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Sponsored
The passage is about sponsors: British Airways 'sponsored' the wheel before it became the EDF Energy London Eye.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Striking
SSC's key gives 'striking': to 'strike a deal' is the set phrase for reaching an agreement. 'Forging' a deal is also heard, but 'strike' is the usual verb with 'deal', and 'discovering' and 'hedging' do not fit.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) WIV
The first letters run T, U, V, W, X (+1), the second O, M, K, I, G (–2) and the third M, P, S, V, Y (+3): WIV.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 196
The terms are the squares of 11 to 16: 11^2, 12^2, 13^2, $14^2 = 196$, 15^2 and 16^2.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 29 : 31
17 and 19 are consecutive prime numbers, 2 apart; so are 29 and 31. 27 is not prime, and neither 43 and 53 nor 31 and 41 are consecutive primes.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 87
The letters' places in the alphabet are added and the sum multiplied by 3: GANT → (7 + 1 + 14 + 20) × 3 = 126 and PROM → (16 + 18 + 15 + 13) × 3 = 186. So GAIL → (7 + 1 + 9 + 12) × 3 = 87.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Both conclusions I and II follow
All N are X and all X are B, so all N are B (I). As all X are B, some B are X (II). Both follow.

Q.7 · Answer (B) EL
The first letter moves 4 places forward and the second 2 back: R → V and L → J. So A → E and N → L: EL.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 12
After the interchanges: 3 × 5 – 6 + 9 ÷ 3 = 15 – 6 + 3 = 12.

Q.11 · Answer (B) DGJC
Each letter moves 2 places back: GAP → EYN and MAD → KYB. So FILE → DGJC.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Equation II
After interchanging the signs, I becomes 17 × 21 + 86 ÷ 2 – 13 = 357 + 43 – 13 = 387, which is correct. II becomes 10 + 63 × 12 – 259 ÷ 7 = 10 + 756 – 37 = 729, not 739.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Only I follows
No radish is an apple, but nothing stops every radish being a tomato that is not an apple, so I is a possibility. No statement links radishes and tomatoes for certain, so II does not follow.

Q.14 · Answer (D) B7, B4, B1
Facing the centre, left is clockwise. Going clockwise from B6 the order is B6, B2, B3, B7, B4, B1, B5. In three options each boy is second to the right of the one before (B3, B6, B1; B6, B1, B7; B2, B5, B4); in B7, B4, B1 each is the immediate left neighbour of the one before.

Q.15 · Answer (D) QJKD
The first two letters move 1 place forward and the last two 1 place back: SLID → TMHC and LIST → MJRS. So PILE → QJKD.

Q.16 · Answer (B) FC
B sits between D and C, F between D and A, and E between A and C, so the order round the table is F, D, B, C, E, A. F is at the middle of one shorter side, so C, three places away, is at the middle of the other, directly opposite F. The corners opposite each other across the centre are D and E, and B and A.

Q.17 · Answer (B) G
C is fifth (four have more), E is last and D third. G has more than D, while A is not the highest, F has fewer than D and B fewer than G, so only G can have the most.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 162
Each second number is half the square of the first: $8^2/2 = 32$ and $12^2/2 = 72$. So $18^2/2 = 162$.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 28
Taken in threes, the first terms rise by 3 (16, 19, 22, 25), the second by 5 (32, 37, 42, 47) and the third by 7 (14, 21, ?, 35), so ? = 28.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 1
'Cakes' is common to the first two sentences and 3 to their codes; 'are' is common to the last two and 5 to their codes. That leaves 1 for 'sweet'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 32812
Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet: G7 R18 A1 Y25 → 718125 and F6 O15 M13 K11 → 6151311. So C3 B2 H8 L12 → 32812.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Exhaustion
Water relieves thirst and food relieves hunger; likewise rest relieves exhaustion.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Bandha Nritya
SSC's key gives Bandha Nritya, the acrobatic part of Gotipua, Odisha's tradition in which young boys dressed as girls dance in praise of Jagannath and Krishna, holding difficult poses called bandha. Garba is from Gujarat, Bhangra from Punjab and Lavani from Maharashtra.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Article 44
Article 44, a Directive Principle of State Policy, asks the State to endeavour to secure a uniform civil code. Article 40 deals with village panchayats, Article 42 with just and humane conditions of work and maternity relief, and Article 46 with the interests of weaker sections.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Money supply
Money supply is the total stock of money, currency and deposits, held by the public at a point in time.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Tanvi Shah
Tanvi Shah, who wrote the Spanish lyrics of 'Jai Ho' from 'Slumdog Millionaire', shared the 2010 Grammy for Best Song Written for Motion Picture, Television or Other Visual Media.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 17
The election of April-May 2019 was the 17th general election to the Lok Sabha, counting from the first in 1951-52; the next was not due until 2024.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Palk Strait
The Palk Strait, between Tamil Nadu and northern Sri Lanka, separates the two countries. The Strait of Malacca lies between Malaysia and Sumatra, Gibraltar between Spain and Morocco, and the Bering Strait between Russia and Alaska.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Madhya Pradesh
The Tapi rises near Multai in the Betul district of Madhya Pradesh and flows west through Maharashtra and Gujarat to the Arabian Sea.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 1952
The Government of India began a comprehensive Family Planning Programme in 1952, seeing planned families as a way to better individual health and welfare.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
Under M S Dhoni India won the ICC World Twenty20 in 2007, the ODI World Cup in 2011 and the Champions Trophy in 2013.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Satavahana
Gautamiputra Satakarni was the greatest of the Satavahana kings; his mother Gautami Balashri's inscription at Nasik records his victories over the Shakas.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Maulana Abul Kalam Azad
Maulana Abul Kalam Azad was among the leaders of the Khilafat Movement, with the Ali brothers, Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Atletico de Kolkata
Atletico de Kolkata won the first Indian Super League in 2014, beating Kerala Blasters 1-0 in the final.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Meghalaya
Nongkrem, a harvest thanksgiving festival of the Khasi people, is held at Smit near Shillong in Meghalaya.

Q.14 · Answer (C) 1540
Sher Khan (later Sher Shah Suri), who had beaten Humayun at Chausa in 1539, defeated him again at Kanauj in 1540 and drove him out of India.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Diabetes
In diabetes mellitus the pancreas makes too little insulin or the body's cells respond poorly to it, so blood sugar stays high. Beri-beri is caused by a lack of vitamin B1.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Madhabi Puri Buch
Madhabi Puri Buch, earlier a whole-time member of SEBI, became its first woman chairperson in March 2022, succeeding Ajay Tyagi.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 100
When the exam was held (July 2022), MGNREGA guaranteed at least 100 days of wage employment in a financial year to every rural household whose adult members volunteered for unskilled manual work.

Q.18 · Answer (B) ropeways in hilly areas
Parvatmala, the National Ropeways Development Programme announced in the 2022-23 Budget, is to build ropeways in hilly areas on a public-private partnership basis, in place of roads where these are difficult.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Milkha Singh
'The Race of My Life' (2013) is the autobiography of the sprinter Milkha Singh, written with his daughter Sonia Sanwalka.

Q.20 · Answer (D) dispersion
A prism splits white light into its colours because each colour is refracted by a different amount; this splitting is called dispersion.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Bahadur Shah Zafar
After the revolt was put down, the British tried Bahadur Shah Zafar, the last Mughal emperor, and exiled him to Rangoon in Burma, where he died in 1862.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Rayon
Rayon is made from wood pulp (cellulose) and looks and feels like silk, so it is called artificial silk. Nylon, polyester and acrylic are fully synthetic fibres.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Gulf stream
The Gulf Stream carries warm water from the Gulf of Mexico north-east across the Atlantic. The Labrador, Falkland and Canary currents are cold.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Alarmel Valli
Alarmel Valli, a Bharatanatyam dancer of the Pandanallur style, received the Padma Shri in 1991. Hema Malini received it in 2000 and Narthaki Nataraj in 2019.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Odisha
The Mukteshvara temple at Bhubaneswar, Odisha, a small 10th-century Shiva temple, is known for its carved torana (gateway arch).

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